

# PORTFOLIO

*Professional Skills & Career Journey*

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ANAWALA**

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*A walkthrough of my  
learning, skills, and  
professional journey.*

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# Welcome to My Portfolio



This portfolio represents a personal milestone in my undergraduate journey at the Sri Lanka Institute of Information Technology (SLIIT). It is a curated collection of the lessons I have learned, the professional skills I have developed, and the direction in which I am steering my career.

Through this document I reflect on the soft-skills lectures that shaped how I communicate, present, and conduct myself professionally. I outline a clear Career Development Plan in Quality Assurance, attach an updated Curriculum Vitae, and provide evidence of online courses I have undertaken to strengthen my technical foundation. Together, these sections capture who I am today and who I am working to become.



**Maleesha C. Anawala**

BSc (Hons) in IT · SLIIT

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*Aspiring QA Engineer*

# Hello, I am Maleesha

I am a fourth-year undergraduate at SLIIT, specializing in Information Technology. I am passionate about building dependable software, breaking it intentionally to find what others miss, and turning those discoveries into a better user experience.

My academic journey began at SLIIT Kandy in 2022 before continuing at the Malabe campus from 2023. Alongside my studies I have worked as a Full-Stack Developer at N-MEG Technologies, completed a QA internship at Xenosys Software solutions, and currently serve as a Software QA Engineer at Supply and Logistic Services - IT Department.



EDUCATION  
BSc (Hons) IT -SLIIT



CURRENTLY  
QA Engineer - SLS-IT Department



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# REFLECTIVE *JOURNAL*

*Reflections on six soft-skills lectures that reshaped how I communicate, present, and engage with the professional world.*



# Formal Presentations

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## *Lecture 1*

The first lecture gave me valuable insight into how to design and deliver effective formal presentations. Before this session I was not fully aware of how seemingly small habits could weaken the impact of a talk, but the lecturer made it clear that strong presentation skills are essential in any professional setting.

The most crucial lesson for me was the importance of intentional structure. A successful presentation requires a compelling opening, logically organized main points, and a solid summary to reinforce the core message. I also learned that audience engagement is just as vital. Keeping people attentive relies heavily on my personal energy, my body language, and my ability to make the topic accessible. Reflecting on this, I recognized a few areas for my own improvement. I now know that speaking too rapidly, packing too much text onto slides, or simply reading directly from the screen will only dilute the information I am trying to share.

Ultimately, this session has significantly boosted my confidence and my personal awareness. I have a much deeper appreciation for clarity, solid structure, and true audience connection. As I prepare to transition from my university studies into the professional world, I know these presentation skills will be critical for effectively communicating complex ideas and technical findings to others.



# Business Writing

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## *Lecture 2*

The second lecture focused on Business Writing, a vital skill in the professional world. It highlighted the importance of writing clearly, concisely, and professionally across business contexts such as emails, memos, and reports.

Another powerful takeaway for my professional development was learning how to effectively use a call to action. I realized that giving the reader clear guidance on what to do next is essential when communicating with colleagues, clients, or leadership. The session also provided me with highly practical techniques for sustaining a formal tone. I now understand the subtle but significant impact of avoiding contractions, such as writing out cannot instead of using can't. I also see how choosing the active voice over passive phrasing instantly brings clarity to my writing. Furthermore, this experience highlighted the true value of deliberate word choice. I am making a conscious effort to replace casual terms like get or a lot with stronger, more professional alternatives like receive or numerous. Recognizing the need to step away from slang and overly casual language has completely shifted how I approach my professional correspondence.

Another crucial point was the proper use of abbreviations, where the full term should be said first followed by the abbreviation in brackets. Lastly, the lecturer emphasized the importance of proofreading and revising all professional communication before sending it. This lecture has improved my ability to communicate politely, effectively, and with purpose in business settings.



# Memo & Email Writing

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## *Lecture 3*

The third lecture focused on Memo and Email Writing, and it was particularly insightful especially since I had no prior knowledge about memos. I learned that memos are used for internal communication within organisations to convey important information clearly and concisely. They are commonly used to address issues, inform employees about updates such as policy changes or price adjustments, or persuade management to take action.

The lecturer explained the structure of a memo in detail, including the heading, opening, and closing segments, and highlighted their purposes. A key point I noted was that memos do not include greetings or sign offs like emails do; instead, they maintain a direct and professional tone. We also learned that memos should be signed either at the top near the designation or at the end of the content.

The second part of the lecture revisited formal email writing, reinforcing knowledge I already had clear subject lines, proper salutations, polite professional tone, and a formal signature with full name, job title, and contact details. Overall, this session enhanced my understanding of both memos and emails, equipping me with practical communication tools needed in any professional environment.





# Telephone Etiquette

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## *Lecture 4*

The fourth lecture centred on Telephone Etiquette and emphasised the importance of maintaining professionalism and clarity during phone conversations. I came to understand that, like emails and presentations, telephone communication also demands strong communication skills and a structured approach.

The session outlined three main components of a phone call: the introduction, where the caller identifies themselves; the purpose, which conveys the reason for the call and the conclusion, which confirms any actions or agreements made. A particularly interesting topic was 'listening roadblocks' barriers that hinder effective communication, such as emotional distractions or passive listening. The lecture stressed the value of active listening giving full attention, asking clarifying questions, and staying engaged throughout the conversation.

We also explored how tone of voice plays a crucial role in telephone communication, especially since visual cues are absent. A dull or monotone voice can sound disinterested, while a warm and energetic tone enhances engagement and professionalism. This lecture made me more aware of how to communicate effectively over the phone a skill that is vital in many workplace scenarios.



# Report Writing

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## *Lecture 5*

The lecture on Report Writing was highly insightful and gave me a clear understanding of the structure, purpose, and formatting required in professional reports. Before this session I was unaware of how different a report is from an essay, particularly in terms of style and organisation. I learned that reports are primarily used to present factual information and analysis about a specific issue often aiming to suggest a solution.

A major takeaway was that reports follow a clearly defined structure, unlike essays that focus on continuous prose. Reports include distinct sections starting with the Title Page, followed by a Table of Contents, an Executive Summary (although placed at the beginning, it is written last) and core sections such as Literature Review, Methodology, Findings, Discussion, Conclusion, and Recommendations.

Moreover, I learned the value of headings, subheadings, bullet points, and visuals like tables or charts to improve readability something that distinguishes reports from essays. The lecturer also stressed the importance of proper referencing and citation to uphold academic integrity. This session has given me a practical framework I can apply directly to academic and workplace reports.



# How to Face an Interview

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## Lecture 6

The guest lecture on 'How to Face an Interview' was incredibly valuable and taught me how to better prepare for and perform in professional interviews. Before this session I did not fully realise how much non-verbal communication, structured responses, and thorough preparation could influence the outcome of an interview.

I learned about different types of interviews panel, behavioural, technical, and virtual and how each evaluates not just technical knowledge but also communication skills, confidence, and cultural fit. One of the key insights was the impact of non verbal cues such as eye contact, a firm handshake, confident posture, and appropriate gestures. Another major takeaway was the STAR method (Situation, Task, Action, Result) for answering behavioural questions, which gave me a clear structure for communicating my experiences more effectively.

The speaker also pointed out common mistakes such as rambling, overconfidence, speaking too quickly, or neglecting to research the company. Practical advice for in person and virtual interviews was provided, including tips on professional attire, arriving early, testing technology, and setting up a distraction free environment. A striking fact shared was that 65% of communication is non verbal, which highlighted just how important body language and tone are during an interview.



# 04

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# CAREER

# *DEVELOPMENT PLAN*

*My roadmap to becoming a senior Quality Assurance Engineer — a journey of structured learning, certifications, and increasingly meaningful contribution.*

# Short-Term Goals

0 – 1 YEAR

*Building the foundation: complete my degree, deepen QA fundamentals, and earn my first industry certification.*



01

## Complete Undergraduate Degree

Successfully graduate with my BSc (Hons) in Information Technology from SLIIT, maintain a strong GPA, and complete all specialised coursework and the final-year research project. I will continue to engage in academic projects and technical clubs to strengthen my foundation.



02

## Excel as Software QA Engineer

Maximise impact in my current role at Supply and Logistic Services IT Department by writing thorough test plans, mastering manual testing fundamentals, and learning the team's automation tools. I aim to be recognised as a dependable QA contributor whose bug reports are clear, reproducible, and actionable.



03

## Earn ISTQB Foundation Level

Pursue and pass the ISTQB Certified Tester Foundation Level (CTFL) the global industry-standard certification for software testing. Pair this with hands-on practice in Postman, JIRA, and Selenium WebDriver to build a strong technical portfolio of testing skills.

# Medium-Term Goals

3 – 5 YEARS

*Specialising in test automation and stepping into a senior individual-contributor role where I own quality for an entire product area.*



01

## Senior QA / SDET Role

Transition into a Senior QA Engineer or Software Development Engineer in Test (SDET) position at a product-focused company. Take ownership of end-to-end testing strategy for a major module including test planning, automation framework design, and release sign-off responsibilities.



02

## Master Test Automation

Become fluent in Selenium WebDriver, Cypress, and Playwright for UI automation, plus Postman and RestAssured for API automation. Build and maintain CI/CD integrated automation pipelines using GitHub Actions or Jenkins, and contribute to performance testing using JMeter or k6.



03

## Advanced Certifications

Pursue ISTQB Advanced Level (Test Manager or Test Analyst) to validate strategic testing skills, and earn the AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner certification to understand the infrastructure my software runs on. Begin contributing to QA communities through blog posts and meetups.

# Long-Term Goals

5 – 10 YEARS

*Moving into QA leadership shaping quality culture, mentoring engineers, and contributing to the wider Sri Lankan tech community.*



01

## QA Lead / Test Architect

Step into a QA Lead or Test Architect role where I define the testing strategy across multiple teams, design scalable automation architectures, and embed quality engineering practices from the earliest stages of product design. Mentor a team of QA engineers and SDETs.



02

## Postgraduate Qualification

Pursue a Master's degree specialising in Software Engineering or Quality Engineering, with a focus on AI assisted testing, intelligent test generation, and modern reliability engineering practices. Use the academic depth to drive innovation in my workplace.



03

## Community & Leadership

Contribute back to the Sri Lankan tech community through speaking at local QA meetups, mentoring young women entering testing, and writing about practical software quality. Long term, explore the possibility of co-founding a quality engineering consultancy.



05

# CURRICULUM *VITAE*

*A snapshot of my education, work experience, technical skill set, and academic projects to date.*



# MALEESHA ANAWALA

Software QA Engineer

## CONTACT



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## LANGUAGES

English  
Sinhala

## ABOUT ME

A passionate IT undergraduate with a growing focus on Quality Assurance, software development, and database management. Eager to apply academic knowledge to real-world challenges, particularly in software testing, full-stack development, and mobile application engineering.

## EDUCATION

**2023 — Present**

### BSc (Hons) in Information Technology

*Sri Lanka Institute of Information Technology (SLIIT) Malabe Specialisation in IT*

**2017 — 2019**

### G.C.E. Advanced Level - Bio Science

*Pushpadana Girls' College, Kandy*

## WORK EXPERIENCE

**Feb 2026 — Present**

### Software QA Engineer

*Supply and Logistic Services - IT Department*

**Aug 2025 — Feb 2026**

### Intern QA Engineer

*Xenosys (Pvt) Ltd*

**Aug 2024 — Feb 2025**

### Full-Stack Developer

*N-MEG Technologies (Pvt) Ltd · Django, Angular, REST APIs, PostgreSQL*

# Skills, Projects & References

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

### Programming Languages

C, C++, Java, JavaScript, Python

### Web Development

Django, Angular, MERN Stack, Spring Boot

### Databases

MongoDB, MySQL, PostgreSQL, MS SQL Server

### Tools & Platforms

Git, GitHub, VS Code, Postman, Docker, Jira, Figma

### Quality Assurance

Manual testing, JIRA, Postman, test case design

### Soft Skills

Communication, problem-solving, teamwork, attention to detail

## ACADEMIC PROJECTS

### ● Online Plant Care Management System

MERN Stack, CSS · Group Project (3rd Year)

### ● Online Pet Care Management System

MERN Stack, CSS · Group Project (2nd Year)

### ● Blind Ball Game Application

Android Studio, Kotlin · 2nd Year

### ● Night Book Kids Storytelling App

Android Studio, Kotlin · 2nd Year

### ● Online Transport Management System

HTML, CSS, JS, Java, Apache Tomcat · 2nd Year

### ● Online Music Instruments Store

HTML, CSS, JavaScript, PHP, MySQL · 1st Year

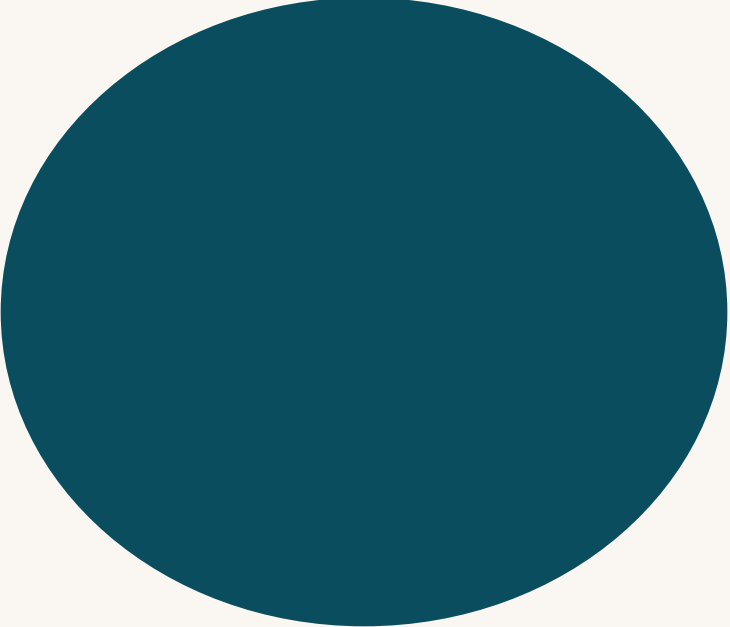
## REFERENCES

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06

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**EVIDENCE OF**  
*COURSES COMPLETED*

*Self-driven online learning to strengthen my QA technical foundation and stay current with industry tools.*



# Postman API Fundamentals - Student Expert

Postman / Postman Academy · Self-paced · Approx. 3–4 hours

## WHAT I LEARNED

- How REST APIs work — endpoints, methods (GET, POST, PUT, DELETE), headers, and status codes.
- Sending requests and inspecting responses inside the Postman client, including using path and query parameters.
- Building Postman Collections to organise tests, and using variables and environments for reusable test setups.
- Writing automated test scripts using JavaScript and Postman's `pm.test()` framework to validate API behaviour.
- Running collections via Collection Runner and Newman for command-line execution and CI integration.

## WHY THIS COURSE

API testing is one of the most in-demand QA skills today. Mastering Postman gives me hands-on capability to validate backend services, automate regression checks, and contribute meaningfully to test automation efforts in any modern software team.



## CERTIFICATE

*Insert certificate image here*

*Replace this box with the Postman Student Expert badge / certificate after completion.*



# Software Testing Foundations

Test Automation University (Applitools) · Self-paced · Approx. 4–5 hours

## WHAT I LEARNED

- The fundamentals of software testing — verification vs validation, the V-model, and the seven testing principles.
- Designing effective test cases using equivalence partitioning, boundary value analysis, and decision tables.
- Distinguishing functional and non-functional testing, and understanding levels: unit, integration, system, and acceptance.
- Writing clear, reproducible bug reports that developers can act on without back-and-forth.
- An introduction to test automation principles and where automation does — and does not — make sense.

## WHY THIS COURSE

This course gave me the formal vocabulary and structured techniques behind everything I do day-to-day as a QA Engineer. It also serves as a strong stepping stone toward the ISTQB Foundation Level certification I plan to earn within the next year.



## CERTIFICATE

*Insert certificate image here*

*Replace this box with your Test Automation University completion certificate after finishing the course.*

# *Thank You*

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*for taking the time to read through my portfolio.*

**Maleesha Chathumini Anawala**

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